TREND INTELLIGENCE · METHOD NOTE

How we pick the top 5 designs and prints

T-shirts · Lehengas · Tie-dye · India · snapshot 28 Oct 2026

A design makes the top 5 when **several independent kinds of evidence** agree it is beating its own normal: Google searches growing faster than the category, marketplaces where it sells better than its share of listings, brand sites where it sells out faster than the same store's other pieces, and social posts that get more likes and views than usual. One loud source can't put a design on the list by itself.

1 · What we collected

	T-SHIRTS	LEHENGAS	TIE-DYE
Google searches read (DataForSEO, India)	24,888	13,822	10,690
...after merging close variants into demand pools	18,133	10,256	6,069
Monthly searches, main category	14.2M	5.6M	1.07M
Growth vs a year ago (last 3 months)	+37%	−23%	+19%
Pieces read on brand websites	13,178 (52 stores)	6,177 (38)	2,481 (30)
Marketplace listings (Google Shopping + Amazon)	480 + 684	480 + 649	480 + 681
Instagram posts with likes	1,057	1,140	983
YouTube videos (views)	734 (443M)	970 (1.2B)	786 (455M)

Cost of this snapshot: 612 SerpApi searches, $1.21 of DataForSEO, and 9,496 of YouTube's free 10,000 daily units.

Myntra, Ajio, Flipkart and Meesho were not scraped. Their terms forbid robots and scrapers, so we read them only as Google Shopping shows them (price, rating, review count), plus Amazon's own "bought in past month" badges.

2 · The four evidence families

FAMILY	WHAT WE COMPARE	COUNTS AS UP	COUNTS AS DOWN
S · Google search	The design's search growth ÷ the category's growth. Needs 300+ searches/month.	≥ 1.08×	≤ 0.92×
M · Marketplaces	Its share of Amazon "bought" + Myntra/Ajio/Flipkart reviews ÷ its share of listings. Needs 5+ listings.	≥ 1.15×	≤ 0.87×

T · Sell-through	How often its pieces are sold out ÷ how often the same store's pieces are. Needs 30+ pieces.	≥ 1.08×	≤ 0.93×
O · Social	Instagram likes vs the account's usual, YouTube views vs typical, and its share of this month's posts.	≥ 1.10×	≤ 0.90×

Each family needs a minimum sample (300 searches a month, 5 listings, 30 pieces), and social numbers built on few posts are pulled toward 1.0×. A design with 9 pieces can't look like a winner just because 3 of them sold out.

3 · Grades

Confirmed 3+ families up and none down, in two weekly snapshots in a row. Likely 2+ up, none down. Leaning up more up than down. Early signal 1 up, nothing down. Mixed as many up as down. Leaning down , Cooling more down than up. Thin data fewer than 2 families have data.

Top 5 takes designs that are a real slice of the market (at least 1% of design searches, 2% of brand-site pieces or 3% of marketplace listings) and are not falling, ranked by grade, then by how many more families are up than down, then by score (the average of the family numbers). If fewer than 5 qualify, a small design that is clearly rising fills the gap, marked *small*. This is the first snapshot, so nothing can be *Confirmed* yet. That needs the next weekly refresh.

> **Worked example: Henley T-shirts**
> Search: 278,111/month, +554% vs a year ago, against +37% for all T-shirts → (1 + 5.54) ÷ (1 + 0.37) = **4.77×** → up.
> Social: likes, views and post share average **2.45×** → up. Sell-through: 13 of 84 pieces sold out, **1.02×** the stores' normal → flat.
> Marketplaces: only 2 listings name Henley, below the 5 needed → no data. Result: 2 up, 0 down → **Likely**, ranked #1.

4 · T-shirt prints

A T-shirt's design is two things: its **style** (fit, neck, fabric: oversized, henley, polo…) and its **print**, meaning what is on it. Prints are mapped in three levels: **world** (Anime, Superheroes, Gods & spiritual, Sports, Music…), **franchise** (Naruto, Spider-Man, Mahadev, RCB…) and **character** (Kakashi, Itachi, Luffy, Gojo…). A character counts towards its franchise and world too. A second dimension, **print style**, covers how it is printed or placed: back print, puff print, all-over, minimal chest logo, typography.

- Each print gets the same four families and grades as designs. Only searches that say "t shirt" count, so "spiderman" alone (the film) is not a tee search.
- Look-alike words are guarded: "Levi" is Levi's jeans unless it says Ackerman or AOT. "Shiv Naresh" and "Duke" are brands, not Mahadev or KTM. "The Bear House" and "American Eagle" are brands, not animals.

- **Culture** is a fifth read, kept out of the grade: Google interest in the show, star or team itself, last 13 weeks against the same weeks a year ago. When culture rises and tee searches haven't yet, the print goes on the **Next wave** list.
- Words searched with "t shirt" that match no print are listed as **spotted, not on our map**, so new prints (a new film, a meme) show up even before we name them.

5 · Life stages

"Who it is for" is read from what people type and how pieces are sold: words like *baby, kids, boys, girls, teen, college, bride, bridesmaid, mom*; sizes (2–3Y, 9–10Y); and style cues (anime, Korean and aesthetic lean teens; oversized, gym and couple lean young adults; polo, office and plus size lean adults). It is a reading of words, not demographic data.

6 · Clean-ups we applied

- **One-month spikes.** Google's data showed "lehenga" at 20.4M searches in Sep 2025 against a usual 0.4M. Months above 8× a query's median are set to its highest normal month. Without this fix, every lehenga design looked like it was rising.
- **Variants.** Google gives close variants the same monthly series. At 20K+ searches, an identical moving series plus a shared word is counted once ("r k tshirt" is the same people as "tshirt").
- **Noise.** Skincare ("salicylic acid wash"), hairstyles for lehengas, jeans and home-dye kits are removed or moved to their own group.
- **Tie-dye patterns.** Titles rarely name the pattern, so Rainbow, Pastel and Monochrome are also read from the colours a title names when it names no pattern.

Limits

- One snapshot shows where things stand now. Two weekly snapshots turn *Likely* into *Confirmed*.
- Tie-dye has the thinnest evidence. Most listings say "tie dye" without the pattern, so its grades are mostly *Mixed*.
- Some lehenga designs (Chikankari, Kalamkari) have little search data under those names. Their grades lean on sell-through and social.
- Brand sites are Shopify stores that publish their catalogue. Myntra, Ajio, Flipkart and Meesho are read only through Google Shopping.

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